

Erlang code

We need to add the code to process the request for the form. The function loop in the file `src/mochiwebx_web.erl` is the one that processes each request. We add a line to call a function as follows:

```
loop(Req, DocRoot) ->
    "/" ++ Path = Req:get(path),
    try
        case Req:get(method) of
            Method when Method == 'GET'; Method == 'HEAD'
        ->
            case Path of
                "webapp" -> webapp(Req);
                _ ->
                    Req:serve_file(Path, DocRoot)
            end;
        (rest of the function as is)
    end;
```

We also add the function `webapp` to process the form and return the response as follows:

```
webapp(Req) ->
    MyList = [{"a",1}, {"b",2}, {"c",3}, {"a",4}, {"b",5}, {"a",6}],
    Data = Req:parse_qs(),
    Key = proplists:get_value("key", Data, "NONE"),
    SendList = [ {X,Y} || {X,Y} <- MyList, X == Key ],
    {ok, HTMLOutput} = webapp_dtl:render([the_list,
    SendList])),
    Req:respond(200, [{"Content-Type", "text/html"}],
```

```
HTMLOutput})).
```

In this simple example, we have used a hard-coded list, filtered it using a list comprehension and returned it in the same template.

A JSON response

An app on a mobile may not need an HTML page and it will be best to send a JSON response. We replace the call to `render` by a call to `mochijsn2:encode` in the `webapp` function as follows:

```
%%{ok, HTMLOutput} = webapp_dtl:render([the_list,
SendList])),
HTMLOutput = mochijsn2:encode(SendList),
```

The form will no longer be displayed but we can test it in a browser by using a URL like `http://localhost:8080/webapp?key=a`

Writing a Web application using Erlang is not difficult too. Even a trivial application is effortlessly scalable; so, Erlang is an option well worth exploring. 

References

- [1] http://alexmarandon.com/articles/mochiweb_tutorial/
- [2] <https://github.com/erlydtl/erlydtl/wiki>
- [3] <http://www.metabrew.com/article/a-million-user-comet-application-with-mochiweb-part-1>

By: Anil Seth

The author has earned the right to do what interests him. You can find him online at <http://sethanil.com>, <http://sethanil.blogspot.com>, and reach him via email at anil@sethanil.com

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